First Congregational Church of Los Angeles
Fall Series 9
Sacred Earth, Sacred Soul ~ Sacred Remembrance
1 November 2026

Preaching: ML
Worship Leading: Pastors

Choir's Presentation
Strips of paper in programs for prayers, mementos laid on Communion Table

Organ Prelude-Concert

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Chiming of the Hour

[Laura and Michael center chancel]

Welcome **LVF**

Words of Gathering **ML & LVF**

L: ***Please stand now, in body or in spirit, for our Hymn of Gathering.***

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

***Hymn of Gathering**

[Laura center chancel]

***Prayer of Awareness** **LVF**

***Introit**

[Michael center chancel]

***The Lord's Prayer** **ML**

[All turn towards altar]

***Gloria Deo**
Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.
World without end, Amen, Amen.

[Laura center chancel]

***Passing of the Peace** **LVF**

This morning, may the peace of God be with you.
And also with you!

You are now invited to share this greeting with those near you.

Please be seated

[Michael center chancel]

Reading from the Wisdom of Our Tradition **ML**

This is the witness of the people.
Thanks be to God!

[Christoph short transition LVF center chancel]

Prayers with the People **LVF**

Invitation to Silence and Prayer
In stillness we open our hearts
to the whisper of Holiness.
Chords of music
fill us with deep reverence
for the wonders we see and know in creation.
The rhythms of life come constant to us
through the blessing of music
and steady…our…pulse…
Let us overflow with the gift of the past and present
and feel the sacred in each note,
each chord,
each harmony of life,
as we are in silence, together...

Silence

Prayer of Our Hearts

[Christoph transition Michael to pulpit]

Reflection ***Sacred Remembrance*** **ML**

[Christoph transition for choir]

Musical Gift ***Becoming Earth***

An Oratorio curated and conducted by Dr. Ianthe Marini and Dr. Fahad Siadat
Featuring Cathedral Choir, Laude, Soloists, and Dr. Christoph Bull (Piano and Organ)
In this oratorio, we honor the sacredness of each life as it passes through the cycle of Earth to Breath, to Earth again.

Precious Lord, Take my Hand — Thomas Dorsey, arr. Arnold Sevier
Laude, Dr. Ianthe Marini, *Conductor*

Clare Harner's In Remembrance, Poetic recitation by Meg Russett

In Remembrance — Music: Eleanor Daley, Text: Clare Harner
Cathedral Choir, Dr. Ianthe Marini, *Conductor*

I Will Be Earth — Music: Gwyneth Walker, Text: May Swenson
Tiffany Ho and Kion Heidari, *Soloists,* Dr. Christoph Bull, *Piano,*
Cathedral Choir, Dr. Ianthe Marini, *Conductor*

More Than Enough — Music: Susan LaBarr, Text: Wendell Berry
Frank Hobbs, *Soloist,* Cathedral Choir, Dr. Fahad Siadat, *Conductor*

A Reading from Robin Wall Kimmerer's Braiding Sweetgrass – Dr. Jay Prewitt Cruz

Last Will — Music and Text by Aria Gittelson
Laude, Dr. Christoph Bull, *Piano*

As One Sky — Music: Paul John Rudoi, Text: Kabir
Anna Caplan, *Soloist,* Cathedral Choir, Dr. Ianthe Marini, *Conductor*

I Came to this Life in Joy — Music and Text by Lauren Spavelko
Molly Pease, *Soloist,* Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organ,* Cathedral Choir, Dr. Fahad Siadat, *Conductor*

[Christoph transition Laura center]

Invitation to Generosity **LVF**

Offertory- This will be Christoph

[All turn towards altar]

***Doxology**
From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator's praise arise!
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!
[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

[Michael center chancel toward end of doxology]

***Offering Prayer** **ML**

Please be seated

[Laura & Michael center chancel]

Life at First Church **ML & LVF**

Words of Blessing **ML**

May it be so.
May it be so for all of us!

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

***Hymn for the Journey**

No Choral Response

[Michael center chancel]

Postlude

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Inside The Music- Dr. Ianthe Marini